

CHAPTER 04

LAND OF PAKISTAN



MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The total area of Pakistan is _____ sq km.
2. The total area of Sindh is _____ sq km.
3. The total area of Punjab is _____ sq km.
4. The total area of Balochistan is _____ sq km.
5. The total number of seats in the Senate Committee is _____.
6. The road linking Pakistan with China is called _____.
7. There are _____ divisions in Sindh.
8. The highest military award of Pakistan is _____.
9. The highest civil award of Pakistan is _____.
10. The biggest province of Pakistan by area is _____.
11. The biggest province of Pakistan by population is _____.
12. The head of state of Pakistan is called _____.
13. The head of the federal government is called _____.
14. The highest court in Pakistan is the _____.
15. The total number of seats in the National Assembly is _____.
16. The total number of seats in the Punjab Assembly is _____.
17. The total number of seats in the KPK Assembly is _____.
18. The total number of seats in the Balochistan Assembly is _____.
19. The National Assembly is elected for a term of _____ years.
20. Zulfikar Ali Bhutto was hanged in _____.
21. The length of the Indus River is _____.
22. The length of the Beas River is _____.
23. The length of the Jhelum River is _____.
24. The length of the Chenab River is _____.
25. The length of the Ravi River is _____.
26. The length of the Sutlej River is _____.
27. Mangla Dam was constructed on the _____ River.
28. Warsak Dam was constructed on the _____ River.
29. The total forest area of Pakistan is _____.
30. Pakistan has _____ natural regions.
31. Pakistan is divided into _____ climate regions.
32. The length of the Khyber Pass is _____.
33. The highest peak in Pakistan is _____.
34. The height of K-2 is _____ meters.
35. The height of Nanga Parbat is _____ meters.
36. The hottest place in Pakistan is _____.
37. The coldest place in Pakistan is _____.
38. Tarbela Dam is built on the _____ River.
39. The first Governor General of Pakistan was _____.
40. The first Governor General of India was _____.

SHORT ANSWERS

Location of Pakistan

The Islamic Republic of Pakistan is one of the most strategically important countries in South Asia, covering an area of 796,096 square kilometers. According to the 1998 Census, Pakistan's population is approximately 130 million, making it the sixth most populous country in the world. Pakistan is divided into four provinces—Punjab, Sindh, Khyber

Pakhtunkhwa (KPK), and Balochistan—along with Gilgit-Baltistan (a region with special status).

The capital of Pakistan is Islamabad, which is located in the northern part of the country, offering proximity to important regions such as Azad Kashmir and Gilgit-Baltistan.

Geographical Location and Neighboring Countries:

1. North of Pakistan: China

In the north of Pakistan, the country shares a border with China. This region is known for its high mountain ranges, including the Himalayas and the Karakoram Range, which includes some of the highest peaks in the world, such as K2. Many of the major rivers in Pakistan, such as the Indus River, originate from the northern mountains, which play a crucial role in the country's agriculture and water supply.

The Karakoram Highway, which connects Pakistan's Gilgit-Baltistan region to China's Xinjiang province, is a remarkable engineering feat, often referred to as the Eighth Wonder of the World.

The highway facilitates trade, tourism, and cultural exchange between the two countries. Pakistan and China have enjoyed excellent diplomatic relations since the beginning of Pakistan's existence. The two countries have strong economic ties, with China being a key partner in terms of trade, investment, and infrastructure development in Pakistan, including significant projects under the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC).

2. North-West of Pakistan: Afghanistan

To the north-west, Afghanistan shares a border with Pakistan. This border is known as the Durand Line, which is approximately 2,252 kilometers long. The Durand Line was drawn in 1893 by the British during their rule over the Indian subcontinent, and it remains a contentious issue between the two countries.

Afghanistan is a landlocked country in Central Asia with an Islamic identity, and like Pakistan, it faces similar political, economic, and security challenges. The two countries have maintained good trade relations and both are members of the Economic Cooperation Organization (ECO), which promotes regional cooperation and economic development.

Despite their historical ties, relations between Pakistan and Afghanistan have been strained at times due to border issues, cross-border terrorism, and political differences. However, Pakistan continues to work towards fostering peace and stability in the region through dialogue and cooperation.

3. South-West of Pakistan: Iran

To the south-west, Iran shares a border with Pakistan. The two countries have enjoyed cordial relations since the creation of Pakistan, and Iran was the first country to formally recognize Pakistan in 1947. Iran is one of the leading oil-producing countries in the world and a founding member of the Economic Cooperation Organization (ECO), alongside Pakistan.

Pakistan and Iran share deep historical, cultural, and religious ties, as both are predominantly Muslim countries, with large Shia Muslim populations. These ties have fostered mutual cooperation in trade, energy, and security. Iran plays an important role in Pakistan's energy sector, particularly in providing natural gas through pipeline projects.

4. East of Pakistan: India

To the east, Pakistan shares its longest border with India, a country that is one of the world's largest democracies and the second most populous nation globally. The two countries have a complex relationship, with the issue of Kashmir being the primary source

of tension. The Kashmir conflict remains unresolved since the partition of India in 1947 and has led to several wars and skirmishes, most notably in 1947–1948, 1965, and 1971.

Despite these tensions, Pakistan has made continuous efforts to establish better relations with India, emphasizing peaceful coexistence and diplomatic solutions to their differences. However, the Kashmir issue remains a sensitive and unresolved matter that hinders full normalization of bilateral relations.

India and Pakistan also have trade relations, but these have been subject to frequent interruptions due to political conflicts. Both countries are also nuclear powers, adding an element of strategic stability in the region.

Conclusion:

Pakistan's strategic location in South Asia places it at the crossroads of several major geopolitical interests. It shares borders with key regional players like China, Afghanistan, Iran, and India.

This geographic positioning provides Pakistan with both opportunities for regional cooperation and challenges related to security, trade, and political relations. The country's foreign policy is influenced by its interactions with these neighboring countries, and Pakistan continues to work towards fostering peace, stability, and prosperity in the region.

Mountain Region of Pakistan: Detailed Overview

Pakistan is home to some of the world's highest and most spectacular mountain ranges. The mountainous regions of Pakistan are strategically significant, offering breathtaking landscapes, rich biodiversity, and hosting some of the world's most renowned peaks, including K2, the second-highest mountain on Earth. These regions are also crucial for Pakistan's economy, culture, and tourism.

1. The Himalayan Range

The Himalayas stretch across northern Pakistan, primarily in the Azad Jammu and Kashmir (AJK) region, as well as parts of Gilgit-Baltistan. This range is known for its towering peaks, glaciers, and deep valleys.

Key Features:

- **Highest Peak:** Nanga Parbat (8,126 meters / 26,660 feet), the ninth-highest mountain in the world. It is famous for its difficulty in climbing, earning it the nickname "Killer Mountain."
- **Major Glaciers:** The Rupal Glacier and Haramosh Glacier are significant in this region, feeding into the Indus River system.
- **Mountain Passes:** The Pir Panjal Range forms the backdrop to famous mountain passes like the Pir Panjal Pass, connecting various parts of the Kashmir region to the plains of India.

Significance:

- **Tourism and Mountaineering:** The Himalayas, especially Nanga Parbat, attract mountaineers and trekkers from around the world. Other popular trekking areas include Ratti Gali Lake and Neelum Valley.
- **Hydrology:** These mountains contribute to the flow of rivers like the Jhelum and Chenab, which are crucial for irrigation and water supply in Pakistan.

2. The Karakoram Range

The Karakoram is one of the longest mountain ranges in the world and lies mainly in the Gilgit-Baltistan region. The range stretches from Pakistan into India and China, and it

houses some of the world's highest peaks.

Key Features:

- **Highest Peak:** K2 (8,611 meters / 28,251 feet), the second-highest peak on Earth after Mount Everest.
- **Other Prominent Peaks:** Broad Peak (8,051 meters), Gasherbrum I (8,080 meters), Gasherbrum II (8,035 meters), and Masherbrum (7,821 meters).
- **Glaciers:** The Baltoro Glacier is one of the most famous glaciers in the world, serving as the starting point for treks to K2 base camp.

Significance:

- **Mountaineering Hub:** The Karakoram Range is renowned for its challenging climbs, attracting top mountaineers globally. It is home to K2, which is considered one of the most dangerous climbs.
- **Karakoram Highway:** The Karakoram Highway, known as the Eighth Wonder of the World, connects Pakistan with China. It is a major trade route and offers a gateway for tourists to access the majestic peaks.
- **Indus River Source:** The range is also crucial as it feeds into the Indus River system, providing essential water for agriculture in Pakistan.

3. The Hindu Kush Range

The Hindu Kush mountains extend from Afghanistan into northern Pakistan, particularly the Chitral District in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP). This range is significant for its strategic position and rich cultural history.

Key Features:

- **Highest Peak:** Tirich Mir (7,708 meters / 25,289 feet), which is the highest peak in the Hindu Kush.
- **Glaciers:** The Khuner Glacier and Tirich Glacier are important glaciers in the region.

Significance:

- **Strategic Importance:** The Hindu Kush region has been historically significant for trade routes and military movements. It is near the borders with Afghanistan and serves as a crossroad between Central and South Asia.
- **Cultural Hub:** The region is home to unique ethnic groups, such as the Kalash people of the Kalash Valley, who have a distinct culture and religion.

4. The Salt Range

The Salt Range is an important geological feature in Pakistan, stretching from the Jhelum River in the north to the Sargodha District in the south.

Key Features:

- **Salt Deposits:** The Salt Range is known for its large salt mines, particularly the Khewra Salt Mine, which is one of the largest in the world.
- **Height:** The range itself is not as high as the Himalayas or Karakoram but has peaks rising up to 1,500 meters (4,920 feet).

Significance:

- **Economic Importance:** The Khewra Salt Mine is a key source of income for the region, producing millions of tons of salt annually. The mines are also an important tourism site.
- **Geological Feature:** The range offers a unique insight into the geological processes of sedimentary rock formations and salt deposits.

5. The Sulaiman Mountains

The Sulaiman Mountains stretch across southern Pakistan, primarily in Balochistan and parts of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. These mountains form the natural boundary between the Indus Valley and the Balochistan Plateau.

Key Features:

- **Height:** The highest peaks in this range are around 3,487 meters (11,440 feet).
- **Geographical Importance:** The Sulaiman Range is rich in mineral resources and is historically significant as a boundary marker.

Significance:

- **Cultural Heritage:** The region has historically been a place of human settlement, with remnants of ancient cultures, including the Mohenjo-Daro civilization.
- **Ecological Importance:** The range has unique flora and fauna due to its varied climate and elevation changes.

6. The Western Ghats (Baluchistan Region)

The Western Ghats also impact Pakistan's southwestern borders, particularly Balochistan, where mountainous terrain shapes much of the region's geography.

Key Features:

- The Western Ghats form a distinct boundary for Pakistan's southern regions, providing rainshadow areas for unique biodiversity.

Significance:

- These areas are vital for both wildlife conservation and local economies, especially with agricultural activities in the region.

Conclusion: Significance of Pakistan's Mountain Regions

Pakistan's mountain regions are of immense importance for various reasons:

1. **Strategic Importance:** Many of the mountain regions serve as natural defense barriers and are strategically important, especially along Pakistan's borders with India, Afghanistan, and China.
2. **Natural Resources:** The mountains are rich in minerals, water resources, and biodiversity, contributing significantly to the country's economy and energy needs.
3. **Tourism:** The mountainous areas, especially the Karakoram and Himalayas, are internationally recognized for adventure tourism. Pakistan's mountain tourism industry is a potential source of revenue and global recognition.
4. **Agriculture:** These regions are also important for their water resources, which are crucial for the Indus River System, supporting Pakistan's agricultural sector.
5. **Cultural Diversity:** The mountains are home to a wide variety of ethnic groups with distinct cultures, languages, and traditions. These include the Kalash people in Chitral, the Hunza Valley people, and various other tribes in the Gilgit-Baltistan region.

1. The Plateau Regions of Pakistan

Plateaus are elevated flatlands or areas that have been uplifted over time, offering a unique geographical and ecological environment. In Pakistan, plateaus are mostly located in the Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa regions.

Key Plateaus of Pakistan:

1. Balochistan Plateau:

- The Balochistan Plateau is the largest plateau in Pakistan, stretching across the Balochistan province. It lies between the Sulaiman Mountains to the east and the Iranian

• The plateau is composed of rocky terrain, with significant desertification in some parts. The region is largely barren but has important mineral resources like coal, natural gas, and salt.

Key Features:

- **Height:** The plateau is 1,200 to 2,000 meters above sea level.
- **Climate:** The region has an arid climate with extreme temperature variations between summer and winter.

Significance:

- **Economic Importance:** The plateau is rich in mineral resources, especially natural gas and oil. It also has potential for agriculture in areas where irrigation is feasible.
- **Strategic Importance:** This plateau is strategically located, connecting Pakistan with Iran and serving as a potential gateway for trade between the two countries.

2. Pothohar Plateau:

- Located in the Rawalpindi and Islamabad regions, the Pothohar Plateau lies to the north of the Salt Range. It is an important geographical area due to its role in the Indus River system.
- The plateau is known for its agricultural productivity, cultural heritage, and its connection to historical sites.

Key Features:

- **Height:** The average elevation is about 600 to 1,200 meters.
- **Climate:** It experiences a moderate climate, conducive to farming, with hot summers and mild winters.

Significance:

- **Agriculture:** The region is fertile and has a rich history of farming, with crops like wheat, barley, and cotton being grown.
- **Cultural Heritage:** The area has archaeological significance, including prehistoric sites like Taxila, a UNESCO World Heritage site.

2. Coastal Areas of Pakistan

Pakistan's coastline stretches along the Arabian Sea and has a significant role in the country's economy, particularly in terms of trade, fishing, and marine resources. The coastal region mainly consists of the Sindh and Balochistan provinces.

Key Coastal Areas of Pakistan:**1. Makran Coast (Balochistan):**

- The Makran Coast is a rugged and arid coastline that stretches from Gwadar in the west to Karachi in the east. It is one of Pakistan's most strategically important coastal areas, with Gwadar Port being a key location.
- The region is known for its mountainous coastlines, desert beaches, and unique coastal ecosystems.

Key Features:

- **Length:** The Makran coastline extends for about 800 kilometers.
- **Climate:** The climate is dry and hot, with limited rainfall, but it supports a biodiverse marine ecosystem.

Significance:

- **Port and Trade:** Gwadar Port is a deep-sea port and a hub for international trade, particularly with China and other Central Asian countries through the China Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC).

• **Fishing and Marine Resources:** The Makran Coast is rich in fishery resources, supporting a significant portion of Pakistan's fishing industry.

2. Sindh Coastal Area:

- The Sindh Coast is located along the Arabian Sea, with the city of Karachi serving as the central economic and trade hub of Pakistan.
- The coastline includes sandy beaches, estuaries, and tidal mudflats, with key locations like Manora Island, Hawksbay, and Clifton Beach.

Key Features:

- **Length:** The Sindh coastline is about 350 kilometers long.
- **Climate:** This region experiences a hot and humid climate, with occasional monsoon rains that affect the coastal areas.

Significance:

- **Karachi Port:** Karachi's ports are critical for Pakistan's international trade, handling the bulk of imports and exports.
- **Tourism:** The coastal areas, especially around Karachi, are popular tourist destinations with recreational beaches and water activities.

3. Deserts of Pakistan

Pakistan is also home to several arid and semi-arid regions, known as deserts, which contribute to the country's unique geographical diversity. These deserts are mostly located in the southern and eastern parts of the country, particularly in the Sindh, Punjab, and Balochistan provinces.

Key Deserts of Pakistan:

1. Thar Desert (Sindh and Rajasthan):

- The Thar Desert is one of the largest deserts in the world and spans across the southern part of Sindh in Pakistan and parts of Rajasthan in India.
- The desert is characterized by sand dunes, sparse vegetation, and a harsh climate, but it also supports a unique human population with a strong cultural heritage.

Key Features:

- **Area:** It covers an area of about 175,000 square kilometers, with a significant portion in Pakistan.
- **Climate:** Extremely hot and arid, with temperatures reaching as high as 50°C in the summer.
- **Flora and Fauna:** Despite the arid conditions, the desert is home to wildlife such as chinkaras, desert foxes, and various species of birds.

Significance:

- **Water Scarcity:** The desert is home to thirsty populations, dependent on underground water and the Indus River system.
- **Livelihood:** The people living in the Thar Desert mostly rely on livestock farming and agriculture, especially where irrigation is available.

2. Cholistan Desert (Punjab):

- The Cholistan Desert is located in the Punjab province of Pakistan, near the Indus River. It is a continuation of the Thar Desert and is known for its vast sand dunes, dry lakebeds, and sparse vegetation.
- The Derawar Fort is a prominent historical site in the Cholistan Desert.

Key Features:

- **Area:** Spans approximately 26,000 square kilometers.

- **Climate:** Like other deserts in Pakistan, the Cholistan Desert experiences a hot and dry climate with extreme temperature fluctuations.

Significance:

- **Nomadic Lifestyle:** Many nomadic tribes, including the Raikas and Jats, live in the desert, relying on camels, goats, and sheep for their livelihood.
- **Cultural Heritage:** The Cholistan Desert is rich in historical sites, including forts and ruins, and the Cholistan Desert Rally is a popular event attracting tourists.

3. Kharan Desert (Balochistan):

- The Kharan Desert is located in Balochistan and is one of the most remote and less populated regions of Pakistan.
- It is a salt desert, with wide expanses of sand dunes and rocky terrains.

Key Features:

- **Area:** The Kharan Desert covers about 19,000 square kilometers.
- **Climate:** It experiences extreme aridity and high temperatures, with very little rainfall.

Significance:

- **Strategic Location:** Due to its proximity to Iran, the desert region has strategic importance for military and defense purposes.
- **Resource Exploration:** The desert is known for mineral deposits and oil exploration.

Conclusion: Importance of Plateaus, Coastal Areas, and Deserts

1. Economic Contributions: The plateaus of Pakistan, especially the Balochistan Plateau, offer mineral resources like natural gas and oil, while the coastal areas contribute to trade and fishing. Deserts such as the Thar Desert support agriculture and livestock farming despite challenging environmental conditions.

2. Strategic Importance: Many of these areas, especially the coastal regions and plateaus, are strategically located near important trade routes, including Gwadar Port and the Karakoram Highway.

3. Cultural and Ecological Significance: The deserts and plateaus are home to unique ethnic groups and biodiversity, offering a rich cultural heritage and wildlife. The coastal areas contribute to tourism, with popular beach destinations in Karachi.

In conclusion, the plateaus, coastal areas, and deserts of Pakistan offer a wealth of natural resources, strategic locations, and cultural diversity, playing a critical role in the country's development and international relations.

What do you know about the Climate of Pakistan:

Introduction:

Pakistan is located just to the north of the Tropic of Cancer and falls under a subtropical climate. It is positioned in the western part of the monsoon region, which greatly influences its climate patterns. The northern regions of Pakistan, particularly in the mountains, experience cooler temperatures, while the southern plains can be extremely hot during the summer. The country's diverse topography, ranging from high mountains to flat plains and coastal areas, results in a variety of climate zones.

Based on its climatic conditions, Pakistan can be divided into four primary climate regions:

1. Sub-Tropical Continental Highland:

This climate zone includes the northern and north-western mountain ranges of Pakistan, particularly the Himalayas, Karakoram Range, and Baluchistan's mountainous areas.

- **Winter:** Extremely cold, with heavy snowfall in many areas, particularly in higher altitudes.
- **Summer:** Generally cool, but temperatures can vary depending on the altitude. The spring and winter seasons are marked by fog and rainfall.
- **Climate Features:** Due to the mountainous terrain, the weather here is often unpredictable and varies greatly between valleys and peaks. Some areas in this region, such as Murree and Gilgit-Baltistan, are known for their pleasant weather, especially in the summer.

2. Sub-Tropical Continental Plateau:

This region primarily encompasses Baluchistan and some parts of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK). The climate in this region is characterized by extreme weather patterns.

- **Rainfall:** The region experiences only minimal rainfall, typically around 5 cm annually, mostly during the months of January and February.
- **Summer:** Extremely hot, dry, and often dusty winds prevail throughout the year. These winds can create intense heat waves during the summer months.
- **Climate Features:** The lack of significant rainfall and the arid conditions make this area particularly prone to droughts. Cities like Quetta and Chaman experience harsh winters with occasional snow, and scorching summers with little relief.

3. Sub-Tropical Continental Lowland:

This climate region includes the upper Indus plain (in Punjab Province) and the lower Indus plain (in Sindh Province), both of which are heavily populated and agriculturally significant.

- **Summer:** The summers are extremely hot, with temperatures often exceeding 40°C, particularly in the plains of Punjab and Sindh.
- **Thunderstorms and Dust Storms:** In areas like the Peshawar plain, thunderstorms and dust storms are common during the summer months, particularly between May and June. These storms can bring sudden relief from the heat but also pose a danger due to their strong winds and unpredictable nature.
- **Winter:** Winters are mild, especially in comparison to the extreme heat of the summer months. The climate remains relatively dry throughout the year, with limited rainfall.

4. Sub-Tropical Coastland:

This region includes the coastal areas of Sindh and Baluchistan, such as Karachi and Gwadar.

- **Temperature:** The climate is moderate, with relatively mild winters and moderate summers. The difference between maximum and minimum temperatures is generally low.
- **Average Annual Temperature:** The average annual temperature in this region is around 32°C.
- **Rainfall:** The coastal areas receive around 18 cm of rainfall annually, which is relatively low compared to other regions of Pakistan. However, these areas may experience higher rainfall during the monsoon season, which lasts from June to September.
- **Climate Features:** The proximity to the Arabian Sea helps moderate the temperature, providing a more temperate climate compared to the inland areas of the country.

Conclusion:

Pakistan's climate is highly diverse due to its varied geography. From the snow-capped mountains of the north to the hot, dry plains of the south, the country experiences a range of climatic conditions. The monsoon season plays an essential role in providing much-needed rainfall, particularly for the agricultural regions in the Indus plain. However, climate change, coupled with other environmental factors, is increasingly affecting the climate and weather patterns across Pakistan. Understanding Pakistan's climatic regions is vital for agriculture, urban planning, and disaster management.